

Niri Workflow

This is a short doc to document all the up-to-date changes I have for my current workflow 2026-03-17. Similar to LARBS but with no preamble on why CLI and keyboard-driven workflows are superior. I'll just get straight into the meat and potatoes.

Status Bar

I switched to noctalia bar after Floating Pill Waybar. This bar is finally my endgame: minimal distractions and plenty of important information. And only a few things have color, which helps with the distractions. It's an excellent bar despite running at ~300-500 MB, almost 9-10x more than Waybar, but I think it's worth it.

Keybindings

These are still Luke Smith-esque with my tweaks.

Only master/stack with a 50/50 split and monocle for fullscreen mode layouts are used. I tried scrolling roughly 3 times, but not for long, less than two days, and I don't think it's for me. Instead I discovered groups/tabs, which I think are superior to scrolling and basically tackle the same problem of having more than two windows on one monitor and the third looking like crap because it's too small. Either way, most of my programs are either terminal or TUI based. The main GUI programs I use are:

- Browser
- Anki
- Zathura/PDF viewer
- Gimp (in the future for YT)
- Darktable (in the future for YT)
- OBS (in the future for YT)



Bar

- **Mod+B** – toggle bar on or off
- **Mod+Shift+B** – relaunch bar if necessary



Programs

- **Mod+D** – launch rofi run
- **Mod+Shift+S** – launch rofi passmenu
- **Mod+Enter** – launch terminal(kitty)
- **Mod+Shift+Enter** – launch tmux session viewer (newt)
- **Mod+E** – launch aerc
- **Mod+Shift+E** – launch miniflux(in browser)
- **Mod+W** – launch browser (qutebrowser)
- **Mod+Shift+W** – launch tmux quick sessions
- **Mod+R** – open currently reading pdf
- **Mod+Shift+R** – open pdf/epub picker
- **Mod+N** – launch system monitor (btop)
- **Mod+A** – launch address book(abook)
- **Mod+M** – launch music player (ncmpcpp)
- **Mod+Y** – left click mouse
- **Mod+Shift+Y** – launch wiremix (audio control)
- **Mod+T** – launch torrent UI (stig)
- **Mod+Shift+T** – toggle transmission daemon
- **Ctrl+;** – move mouse left
- **Ctrl+'** – move mouse right

System

- **Mod+Shift+D** – open system utilities menu
- **Mod+C** – clipboard history
- **Mod+Q** – kill active window
- **Mod+Shift+X** – exit niri
- **Mod+Shift+Space** – toggle all windows floating
- **Mod+Backspace** – power menu
- **Mod+Shift+Backspace** – lock screen
- **XF86MonBrightnessDown** – decrease screen brightness by 5% (laptop only)
- **XF86MonBrightnessUp** – increase screen brightness by 5% (laptop only)
- **Alt+=** – system volume +5
- **Alt+-** – system volume -5

Screenshots

- **Print** – screenshot active monitor
- **Mod+S** – screenshot menu

Window Navigation / Layout

- **Mod+L** – cycle next window
- **Mod+H** – cycle previous window
- **Mod+Shift+H** – swap left (window)
- **Mod+Shift+L** – swap right (window)
- **Mod+Space** – swap with master
- **Mod+U** – toggle layout (fake fullscreen)
- **Mod+F** – toggle fullscreen

Groups

- **Mod+G** – toggle group
- **Mod+Shift+G** – move window out of group
- **Mod+I** – lock/unlock group
- **Mod+Tab** – move window into group (left)
- **Mod+Shift+Tab** – move window into group (right)

Workspace / Tab Navigation

- **Mod+J** – move down (workspace or group tab)
- **Mod+K** – move up (workspace or group tab)

Resize

- **Mod+-** – shrink window
- **Mod+=** – expand window

Monitors

- **Mod+comma** – focus left monitor
- **Mod+period** – focus right monitor
- **Mod+Shift+period** – move window to right monitor
- **Mod+Shift+comma** – move window to left monitor

Workspaces

- **Mod+1-0** – switch to workspace 1-10
- **Mod+Shift+1-0** – move window to workspace 1-10

Mouse

- **Mod+LMB** – move window
- **Mod+Shift+LMB** – resize window
- **Mod+Scroll Down** – next workspace
- **Mod+Scroll Up** – previous workspace